

Constructing a Fact or Value Case

Fact or Value cases are simple in their construction. Both sides of the debate will present a series of contentions (arguments) that support their side of the topic. For reference here are a couple samples of topics;

- Smartphones are an effective tool in the classroom. (Fact)
- When in conflict, jobs should be valued over green technology. (Value)

Use this framework when building a Fact or Value based case:

Introductory Remarks

Ingratiation

Statement of Support of Resolution

Observation One: Definitions

Definition of key term #1

Definition of key term #2

Observation Two: Criteria

A. The value, goal or standard

B. The support for the value, goal or standard

C. Decision rule: how the judge will use the value, goal or standard as criteria

Contention One: The first main argument that meets the criteria

A. The first claim necessary to develop the story of Contention One

1. Supporting material (example, analogy, cause, sign, authority)

*2. Possible explanation of the relevance of the sub point to the criteria
(if appropriate)*

B. The second claim necessary to develop the story of Contention One

1. Supporting material (example, analogy, cause, sign, authority)

*2. Possible explanation of the relevance of the sub point to the criteria
(if appropriate)*

C. The third claim necessary to develop the story of Contention One

1. Supporting material (example, analogy, cause, sign, authority)

*2. Possible explanation of the relevance of the sub point to the criteria
(if appropriate)*

Additional Contentions